

Incident Alert 0015. TLP CLEAR.		Date	Breakout Scale
Title	EU – Russian Sanctioned Entities Accessible to EU Audiences on YouTube	30/06/2024	2

Summary

- As of June 28th 2024, at least 24 YouTube channels of Russian media entities banned by the EU, posing as such, or consistently amplifying their content are accessible to EU audiences.
- The pages have 1.7 million followers and 381 million views on YouTube
- Multiple of these channels are monetized, in violation of the Code of Practice Against Disinformation.
- [Council Regulation No 269/2014](#) prohibits hosting content from these channels or making them available to EU audiences on video-sharing platforms, as clarified in [Commission guidance](#) updated mid-May 2024.

Incident – When, Who did what, to say what, to whom, why?

Despite these legal provisions, as of late June 2024, a number of Google services, including YouTube, still make content produced by Russian state-controlled media and media personalities on the [EU sanctions list](#) accessible to European audiences.

On YouTube, some accounts repeatedly or exclusively post content from sanctioned entities. These channels include:

- One influential media account, Afrique Média TV, systematically publishing new content from sanctioned media organization RT while hiding the associated logo or identifiers,
- Two personal accounts of media personalities specifically sanctioned by the EU (see [Annex I of Council Regulation No 269/2014](#)), including one with a large following and monetized content.
- Three accounts with all the hallmarks of official channels of shows broadcast on sanctioned media (name, logo, only posting content produced by the entity),
- Four accounts belonging to journalists or hosts of shows broadcast on sanctioned media entities and who frequently post content from these entities (usually hiding the associated logo or visual identifier),
- 14 amplifier accounts that repeatedly post content produced by sanctioned entities but which do not appear to be directly affiliated with them.

In addition, we found five videos hosted on YouTube that show users ways to bypass the sanctions and access sanctioned Russian Media. Another video explains how to receive Google AdSense revenue in Russia, despite its suspension in the country due to sanctions.

Narrative

N/A

Impact

Reach: The identified accounts have around 1.7 million followers and 381 million views on YouTube (the EU share of which cannot be inferred from public data).

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Facilitate State Propaganda](#) – Spread Russian operational content via YouTube.

[Remove Post Origins](#) – cutting away parts of the video to remove logos.

Recommendations

- Action taken: Case reported to Google (28/06/2024), European Institutions, and EU member states affected.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
Link	Sanctions, Russia	Se report	Charles Terroille , Science Feedback Saman Nazari , A4E	Video, page	YouTube